

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, cloudy, early drizzle, late sun, high 65. **Tonight**, decreasing clouds, low 47. **Tomorrow**, warm, intervals of clouds and sunshine, high 66. Weather map appears on Page 34.

VOL. CLXXV . . . No. 60,817

© 2026 The New York Times Company

SUNDAY, MARCH 8, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00



DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

The remains of six Army Reserve soldiers killed in an Iranian drone attack in Kuwait arriving at Dover Air Force Base in Delaware.

Colleges Respond to Upswing in Disability Diagnoses

By MARK ARSENAULT and STEVEN RICH

The number of college students reporting disabilities rose more than 50 percent over the last decade across a wide swath of schools, including at some of the most selective universities in the nation, according to a New York Times analysis of government data.

The rise, which has corresponded with an increase in A.D.H.D., autism and other diag-

noses, has also meant an increase in the number of students requiring accommodations, such as more time to take tests. While some colleges and students have embraced the trend, saying it shows schools are opening their doors to students who might previously have been shut out, it has raised worries that some could be gaming the system.

The increases have occurred at all kinds of institutions, from small liberal arts colleges to large research universities commanding global reputations.

Accommodations Elicit Debate on Campus

At some colleges, over a third of students have registered physical or mental disabilities, signed off on by doctors. For those students, the schools generally provide the students legally required accommodations that others may not receive, such as special testing rooms and note-taking services.

The proliferation in accommodation plans, known as 504 plans after a section of federal law that prohibits discrimination based on disability, has made even the most academically rigorous universities more welcoming to students with disabilities. Among the top 100 schools that saw the biggest increases in students with disabilities are several in the group known as “Ivy Plus,” some of the most difficult schools in the nation for a student to get into, including

Continued on Page 26

Torrent of Money Transforms a Slice of Wyoming

This article is by Katie Benner, Steven Rich, Mike Baker and John Branch.

JACKSON, Wyo. — At his childhood home in Nebraska that lacked the comforts of television and air-conditioning, Joe Ricketts learned that honest work and neighborly values were keys to success.

After graduating from college, he persuaded friends and family to lend him \$12,500 in seed money for what became Ameritrade, the investing firm that would go on to

BILLIONAIRE BOOM
A New Frontier

disrupt the Wall Street trading establishment and put Mr. Ricketts on a path to riches. By 2015, his wealth had grown to \$1 billion, and even that stunning figure now feels like a quaint memory, as the powerful elixir of rising stocks and falling taxes that has minted new billionaires across the country has catapulted Mr. Ricketts’s personal net worth to \$8 billion.

Along the way, Mr. Ricketts found a new community in and around Jackson, Wyo., a playground for the rich. For some things, he has been celebrated: He has donated to research on the conservation of red squirrels and American beavers. He contributed \$1 million to building a hospital. He has taken pride in building a herd of white bison.

But lately some of his neighbors have come up against the raw power of Mr. Ricketts’s financial

muscle. Many of them fought against a plan he advanced a few years ago to turn his ranch into a resort for wealthy tourists, proposing to bypass regulations that limit construction during the brutal winter months to protect local wildlife.

Then, when community opponents dug in, Mr. Ricketts simply acquired a different piece of land — a \$9 million parcel that officials had hoped to turn into public land.

“There is not much we can do to rein that in,” said Luther Propst, a county commissioner in Teton County, home to Jackson and the mountain outposts that surround it.

The Jackson Hole region has long been a refuge for the rich, but an explosion of new affluence has allowed a growing cadre of extraordinarily wealthy people to

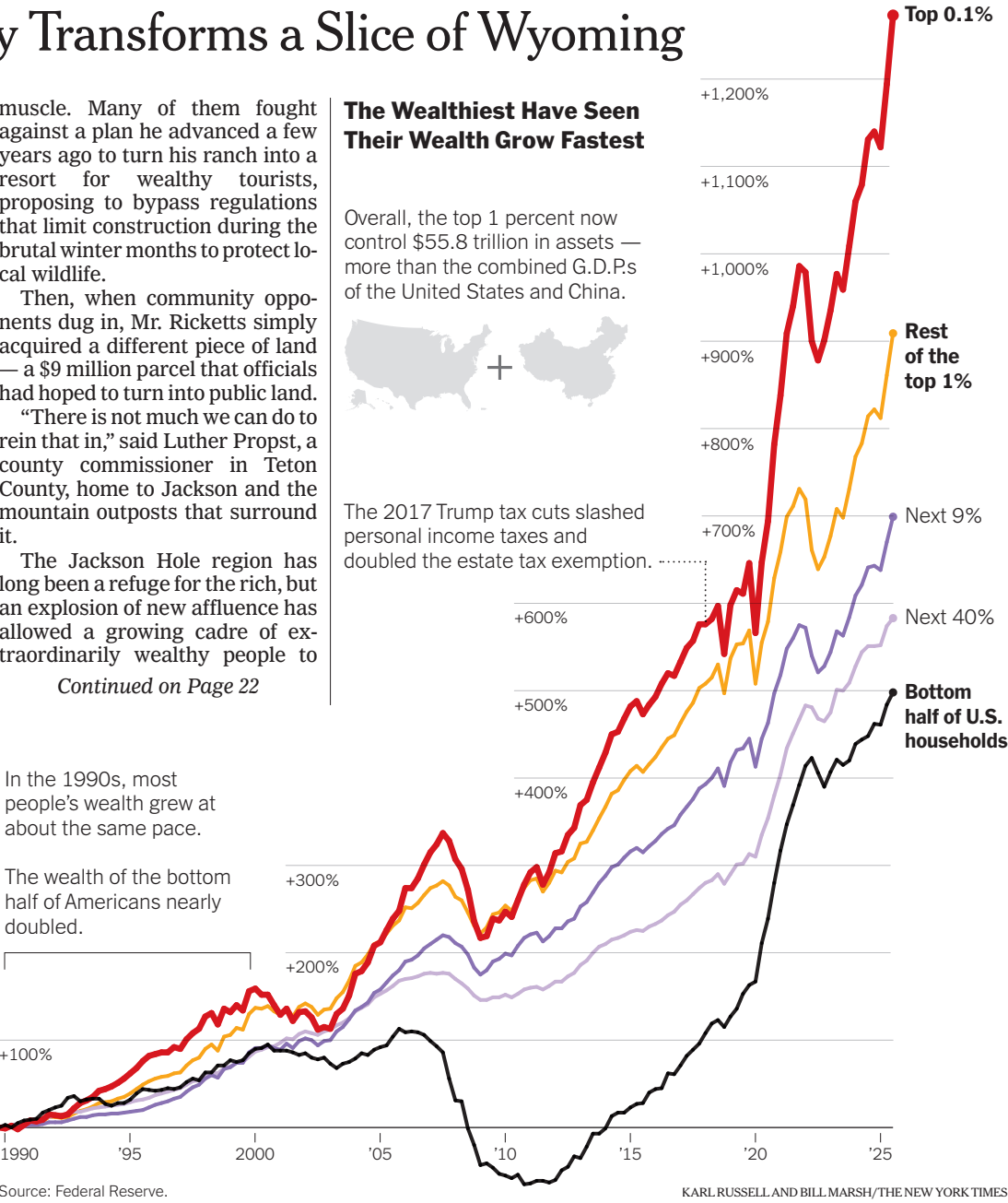
Continued on Page 22

The Wealthiest Have Seen Their Wealth Grow Fastest

Overall, the top 1 percent now control \$55.8 trillion in assets — more than the combined G.D.P.s of the United States and China.



The 2017 Trump tax cuts slashed personal income taxes and doubled the estate tax exemption.



Source: Federal Reserve.

KARL RUSSELL AND BILL MARSH/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Trump Tramples a Line, Worn Faint, on War

A Major Escalation of Presidential Power

By CHARLIE SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — Since World War II, presidents of both parties have found ways to hollow out the Constitution’s constraints on their power to order military attacks.

NEWS ANALYSIS President Trump’s unilateral decision to launch a war against Iran threatens to gut nearly all of what little remains. It is supposed to be a foundational principle of American democracy that unless the United States is under attack, the power to declare war is vested in Congress. But especially since the start of the Cold War, presidents of both parties have chipped away at that by claiming a right to order the military into various limited hostile situations.

Some lawmakers complained. But as an institution, Congress acquiesced. Consistently paralyzed by competing impulses — party loyalty, support for the policy goals of deployments or fear of being accused of undercutting troops already in harm’s way — lawmakers let presidents get away with serial power grabs.

Successive administrations built on their predecessors’ innovations, a one-way ratchet expanding the circumstances in which presidents had claimed and demonstrated that they could by themselves deploy

troops into combat. As precedents accumulated, the split kept widening between how the founders clearly intended decisions about initiating war to be made and how the country was governed in practice.

Even so, the prospect of attacking Iran, absent a literally imminent threat of attack by the country, had stood apart as a textbook example of what would seemingly still require congressional authorization. The potential for rapid spiraling — of retaliatory strikes on U.S. citizens, troops and allies in neighboring countries, of escalation into a bloody regional conflagration with global economic consequences — seemed too extreme a risk for any one person to decide to take on.

Asked to detail its legal analysis, the White House provided a brief statement that described decades of misdeeds by Iran, claiming that Mr. Trump “exercised his authority as commander in chief to defend U.S. personnel and bases in the region.”

It is not clear whether the administration’s internal legal analysis relies on any claim that Iran posed an imminent threat. Neither the White House statement nor a letter Mr. Trump sent to Congress said it did.

But in public statements, Mr.

Continued on Page 12

NEW STRIKES Israel hit a Tehran airport also used as an air force base, and Iran’s leaders rejected President Trump’s call to surrender. **PAGE 10**

SELLING BOMBS TO ISRAEL The State Department declared an emergency and made a deal without congressional approval. **PAGE 14**

Pardon Industry Offers the Rich A Path to Trump

By KENNETH P. VOGEL

OTISVILLE, N.Y. — One evening last November, word spread around the federal prison camp in Otisville, N.Y., that an inmate who had spent heavily to pursue clemency had hit pay dirt, winning a pardon from President Trump and walking free.

His release intensified a continuing debate for those who were left behind. Whom could they pay to achieve the same result?

There was a lot to parse in the clemency campaign of Joseph Schwartz. He had served only three months of a three-year sentence for tax crimes related to a nursing-home empire that had collapsed amid allegations of endangering the residents and defrauding his employees.

Mr. Schwartz had not been shy about sharing the strategy behind his clemency campaign with other inmates, so they knew he had paid multiple people to try to get the job done, according to two people familiar with conversations at Otisville.

Nearly a million dollars went to right-wing operatives who claimed to have worked with Laura Loomer, a social media provocateur who has the ear of Mr. Trump, to advocate for Mr. Schwartz’s release. Another \$100,000 or more was paid to a lobbyist who had a different set of connections to Mr. Trump — pro-Israel evangelicals.

Thousands more went to lawyers who had personal relationships with Alice Marie Johnson, Mr. Trump’s “pardon czar,” and David Warrington, the White House counsel, according to four people familiar with the effort.

Mr. Schwartz’s supporters employed various techniques and ar-

Continued on Page 16



YE FAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Bob Krinsky moved to a two-bedroom with sweeping views.

Retiring Move? Baby Boomers Pick New York.

By WINNIE HU

Bob Krinsky roused his much younger neighbors for a three-mile run in howling winds along the icy Brooklyn waterfront. Afterward, as they thawed out, he called their running club together in a circle.

“OK everybody, hands in,” he said, as they stacked their hands in the center. “This was awesome.”

At 65, he’s the club’s designated C.V.O.: chief vibes officer. “It’s us keeping up with Bob,” said Alexa Brewster, 29. “I wish I was joking, honestly.”

Mr. Krinsky relocated last year from San Francisco to Williamsburg, a former industrial neighborhood in Brooklyn, to be closer to his two grown sons after his 30-year marriage ended. He is starting over in a two-bedroom apartment with sweeping, 47th-floor views of the Manhattan skyline, paying almost \$11,000 a month in rent.

“I’m a 35-year-old man trapped in a 65-year-old body,” he said. “I thrive on the energy here, and I think my youthful vibe contrib-

Continued on Page 21

INTERNATIONAL 4-14

Trump Ramps Up Cartel Fight
The president unveiled a new military coalition consisting of 17 Latin American and Caribbean nations to help the U.S. vanquish trafficking groups. **PAGE 4**

A Test for a ‘Liquor Capital’
Maotai has reeled from a bad Chinese economy, changing tastes and a crack-down on boozy official banquets. **PAGE 6**

NATIONAL 15-26

Changing How a Region Farms
Hundreds of growers in Minnesota are investing in oats. It’s good for the land. But can it work as a cash crop? **PAGE 15**



SUNDAY BUSINESS
Where Big Tech Was Born
Taking a tour of Bell Labs to see how its past shapes modern, and certainly future, technologies. **PAGE 6**

Pentagon’s Unlikely Influencer
Palmer Luckey, founder of a defense tech start-up, has become a player in modernizing the U.S. military. **PAGE 4**

METROPOLITAN

To Burn Parks, or Not?
An outbreak of wildfires in New York City’s parks gave scientists a chance to study these events. Now they’re coming to different conclusions about reducing risks with controlled burns. **PAGE 6**

A.I. in the Classrooms
Will New York, which has the country’s biggest school system, embrace or eschew artificial intelligence in education? That decision could shape the future of a generation. **PAGE 1**

SUNDAY OPINION
Lydia Polgreen **PAGE 6**



SPECIAL SECTION
Endangered Design
Why so many buildings, objects and techniques across the world are hanging on for dear life.

SUNDAY STYLES

Yearning for Steamy Desire
Indulging in fantasy has become more personalized and on demand than ever as people long for connection at a time real-life sex seems in decline. **PAGE 14**

ARTS & LEISURE

Artists Bound by Blood
Works by Andrea Fraser and her mother, Carmen de Montefiores, will appear at the Whitney Biennial. Behind them is a story of deep emotion. **PAGE 12**

